

Course milestone M13: Final Poster Lock

HONR 46400 · Evidence-Driven Research

What to submit

One document, `lastname_m13.pdf`. Everything this milestone asks for goes inside it, as sections in the order below. These artifacts travel beside it, because they cannot live inside a PDF:

Submit it on Brightspace, under **Assignments** then **M13**. Brightspace carries the deadline.

Where this document has a **What this course adds** section, that section is part of the milestone and is graded, whether or not the course schedule marks this milestone.

This milestone presents **Book Milestone 10: Your artifact, ready to publish or present** (revisit, version 3 - the locked print edition) of the course book, EDR|AI.

- `lastname_m13_poster.pdf`: The print-ready poster at URC print spec. It goes straight to the press on a run shared with QM 47400, so it must ship as its own file at print dimensions and cannot be a section inside another PDF.
- `lastname_m13_package.zip` (or a shared folder or repository link): The reusable research package must actually run in a clean session: seeded notebook, data or access recipe, environment record, README, licence, and dated manifest. A runnable bundle cannot live inside a PDF.

What this course adds

Your venue is fixed, and the lock is terminal

The Book Milestone lets you choose a venue. Here the venue is chosen for you: a printed poster for the Purdue Undergraduate Research Expo. Write your venue contract against the URC print spec handed out in class, which sets dimensions, minimum font sizes at print scale, and the required identifying elements. The poster must be legible at printed size, not only on your screen.

This lock is terminal. There is no revision window, because your file goes straight to a shared print run. The poster you submit is the poster strangers read at the Expo. Late work loses 10 points per day for up to three days and is not accepted after that.

Reproduce before you publish

One rule governs the whole week. The numbers that lock onto the poster are the numbers that just reproduced from your clean package. So the package comes first and the poster comes last. Reproduce the uncertainty too: if an interval or bound does not come back, the result has not reproduced, however well the headline number matched. You assemble, run, and clear all of this in the Friday studio.

1. **Assemble your reusable research package.** It has six parts: the seeded notebook (`SEED = 464`, running top to bottom with no manual step); the data or a written access recipe (source, exact URL or archive record, retrieval date, any registration); the environment record of package versions; the README saying what the project asks, what it found, how to run everything, in what order, and where each output lands; the licence with its reuse boundary; and the dated, frozen manifest.
2. **Run it cold and write the record.** A clean environment is a fresh session with nothing left over from your work. Follow only your README. Record the environment and date, a question log of every place the run stalled, and the documentation line you added for each question. Then label it honestly. Working alone, the label is “solo proxy; external cold run pending”. Never soften that into an external run.
3. **Clear Gate 1, your author self-reproduction log.** Restart the runtime, run everything, and list each poster number and each bound beside the value the rerun produced. Mark every pair matched or not matched, and repair each mismatch before you lock.

4. **Clear Gate 2, your release preflight.** This is a short table taken just before the lock, with four rows marked clear, pending, or blocking: permissions, disclosure, reproducibility, and claim boundary.
5. **Lock the poster on those numbers.** Four things are judged on the board itself: one headline claim inside your compass position; every number traceable to a cell in the package you just reran; the uncertainty visible in the same eye-span as the claim; and redundant encoding, so a color-blind or screen-reader reader gets the message too.
6. **Sign off and disclose.** Ship a signed final-lock checklist attesting to traceability, verified citations, uncertainty placement, both gates, and print spec. Put an AI-use disclosure block on or with the poster: which tool did which task, and how you checked it. “No AI used” is fine when true.

Both gates are blocking. They are not scored, and strong work elsewhere cannot average them away. A submission missing a gate record, or carrying a row still marked blocking, is returned rather than graded.

Two more book sections

Complete the “It is your turn” sections of ch. 36 (Replication and Reproduction) and ch. 37 (Open and Reusable Research Packages) in their companion notebooks, and include them.

What you hand in

Your single PDF carries the cold-run record, both gate records, the signed final-lock checklist, your AI Research Ledger rows, and your dossier line. Two things travel beside it: the print-ready poster file and the package itself, as a zip or a shared link set so the instructor can open it. Also send the poster through the URC channel as instructed in class; the Brightspace timestamp is what governs the deadline.

If you are in an approved group, the package and the poster are one shared submission naming every member. Your ledger rows, your checklist sign-off, and your dossier contribution stay individual.

How it is judged

Beyond the Book Milestone rubric, four failures cap a whole criterion no matter how strong the rest is: a fabricated or unretrievable source, a number on the board with no cell behind it, a poster number or bound that does not rerun from your package, and an author rerun presented as independent reproduction. A missing AI Research Ledger returns your submission before it is graded.

Milestone 10: Your artifact, ready to publish or present

Open the milestone workbook in Colab

This chapter closes Studio 10: Prepare to publish or present. Its lessons each ended at **It is your turn**; what you wrote there arrives here as working material, and this is where the pieces become one artifact you can defend.

What this milestone produces. A short venue contract and one artifact ready for publication or presentation that satisfies it - a paper or research note, a seminar or conference talk, a poster, or another venue’s format - with a content map tracing every load-bearing claim and number, and a defense rehearsal record. This is not yet public release.

What you bring

You also carry forward the last milestone’s artifact: **Milestone 9: Your bounded claims**. This one builds on it, and the chain assumes it is versioned and filed.

Check you are carrying each of these before you start. If one is missing, go back and work that lesson’s **It is your turn** first; the practice below assumes it.

- Lesson 35: Difficult Questions and Uncertainty: your five hardest fair questions with defend-or-concede answers, and your uncertainty-and-limitations statement in ULN form.

These pieces are conditional. Bring each one when its condition is yours; when it is not, the lesson’s own drill or a plain skip is the right call, and the milestone does not require the piece.

- Lesson 32: Research Posters: if your venue is a poster, or your format carries a quantitative figure: the draft with labeled values, uncertainty shown as the design licenses (interval or caveat), and a headline verbed to your boundary.

- Lesson 33: Poster Criticism: if your venue is a poster: the gallery-walk audit of your draft, hits ranked by how far the error travels, fixed once, and the lock call.
- Lesson 34: Research Pitches, Talks, and Seminars: if you will speak, whether a pitch, a seminar, or a conference talk: your 30-second and 3-minute spines, built boundary-first, tested aloud on an outsider, and expanded to the venue's length.

Your format decides one more input. For a paper or research note, bring your Milestone 9 note; for a seminar or talk, the pitch spine; for a poster, the visual pieces above; for another format, the nearest row's input plus your venue contract. Difficult Questions is everyone's.

Choosing your format

The goal of this studio is an artifact ready for publication or presentation: a manuscript a venue could receive, a talk a room could hear, a poster a conference could hang. Start with a **venue contract**: your written record of what the audience will receive and what the venue allows. Name the audience, the medium, the length or space limit, the required elements, the accessibility needs, the submission rule, and the question channel. One line each is enough. Example: a five-minute recorded talk, six slides, captions required, no live questions.

Every format carries the same research core: the bounded claim, the evidence that earns it, uncertainty and limitations, traceable numbers and citations, and whatever disclosure or permission information the audience needs. The format only decides where those pieces live. Choose the row that fits your venue, work the lessons it names, and when you borrow a technique from another row, name the technique rather than claiming the whole lesson transfers.

If your venue asks for	build it with	then test and rehearse
a paper or research note	your Studio 9 note, developed to the venue contract: sections, length, references, and the figure rules for any figure	the audit on the manuscript; Difficult Questions in writing
a seminar or conference talk	Research Pitches' spine, expanded section by section to the venue's length; slides follow the poster lesson's figure rules	the audit on the deck; Difficult Questions, spoken
a short pitch	Research Pitches	Difficult Questions, spoken
a poster	Research Posters	Poster Criticism, then Difficult Questions
another format	the venue contract plus the nearest row, naming what transfers	Difficult Questions, in the venue's own mode

The poster lessons are this book's fully worked visual example: one surface, no narrator, every number exposed. The paper route runs on your Studio 9 note; the seminar route runs on the pitches lesson's spine. Difficult Questions is for everyone. If your venue has no live questions, the rehearsal still happens: have a peer or an AI reviewer send you hard questions in writing, and record defend, concede, or do-not-know for each.

The practice

1. Write your venue contract using the guide above, then say what your claim must lose to fit that format.
2. Write a transformation memo from your Studio 9 note: what expands, what compresses, what moves, what becomes visual, and what becomes spoken.
3. Build a content map before you build the artifact: where the claim, the evidence, the boundary, the uncertainty, and the disclosure will each live.
4. Build the artifact to its venue contract, keeping every load-bearing number, figure, and citation traceable to the claim-evidence table.
5. Test it in its actual mode: scan the poster at gallery distance, time the talk aloud, advance the deck without narrating, or hand the manuscript to a cold reader.
6. Rehearse the defense against the three hardest questions you can construct, and record which you could not answer; those are your next studio's agenda.

A version, not a pass

Your milestone artifact is a dated, numbered **version** with the reason for the version attached. When later evidence changes it, you write the next version rather than editing the last one, because the sequence of changes is itself part of your research record.

The four rails, here

Four concerns cross every studio in this book. At this milestone they take these specific forms.

- **Ethics, permissions, and data exposure.** An adaptation that drops the limitations is not a shorter version, it is a different claim.
- **Evidence, provenance, and reproducibility.** Every figure that travels carries its verification with it.
- **AI activity, verification, and human decisions.** If AI edits the artifact or generates questions, record what changed and verify the result; every defend-or-concede decision remains yours.
- **Uncertainty, claim boundary, and revision history.** The shorter the format, the more explicit the boundary has to be.

Where this milestone sits

You arrived carrying Milestone 9: Your bounded claims. Milestone 11 lets strangers rerun what you have just defended, which is the one test rehearsal cannot give you. The chain ends at Milestone 12: Your release and next cycle, where you decide whether your finished research artifact leaves your hands.

What sends you back

A question you cannot answer in rehearsal is evidence, and it sends you back to the studio that owns it.

How this milestone is assessed

Each row scores **0, 1, or 2. 10 points total.**

#	Criterion	0	1	2
1	The milestone artifact exists in full, specific to your own project	absent, or generic text that would fit any project	present but incomplete, or specific in some parts and generic in others	complete and unmistakably about your project
2	The milestone is written as a dated, numbered version with its reason	no version, or a version with no reason given	versioned, but the reason is decorative rather than an account of what changed	versioned with a reason a reader could use to reconstruct your thinking
3	Every judgment in the artifact is defended by you, not asserted by a tool	conclusions appear with no reasoning, or reproduce a tool's wording	reasoning present but thin where the decision was hardest	each judgment carries a reason you could defend under questioning
4	The four rails are carried in the form this studio requires	one or more rails absent where this studio required them	all rails present but one is nominal	every rail addressed in the form this studio requires
5	The milestone's own product is present and defensible: A short venue contract and one artifact ready for publication or presentation that satisfies it - a paper or research note, a seminar or conference talk, a poster, or another venue's format - with a content map tracing	contract, adaptation, content map, or rehearsal absent, or a load-bearing claim exceeds its evidence	all pieces present, but one load-bearing number, boundary, accessibility path, or mode test is incomplete	the adaptation satisfies its declared contract, every load-bearing claim and number is traceable, uncertainty travels with the claim, and the rehearsal records defensible responses plus the unresolved work

#	Criterion	0	1	2
	every load-bearing claim and number, and a defense rehearsal record. This is not yet public release			

! Blocking gate

No work at or after Studio 4 proceeds past a not-authorized determination. This is not scored and cannot be averaged away.

Your workbook

Open the workbook with the link above. It walks these steps with a cell for each one, ends by writing your milestone version with its reason, and adds the rows this studio contributes to your AI Research Ledger and your Research Dossier.